



Small Businesses Together Through Community Events

A8 High-Fi ReadME

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introduction

Stitch is a mobile platform that stitches small businesses together through community events. Create smarter, warmer connections between local businesses and communities by turning collaborations into repeatable, real-world experiences.

context: when & why use Stitch?

When Is Stitch Used?

- When a small business owner wants to find collaboration partners for upcoming community events.
- When a small business owner seeks to expand customer reach through value-aligned partnerships.
- When a small business owner plans a co-hosted event with complementary businesses.

What Should Users Accomplish?

- Discover potential business partners through AI-powered recommendations.

- Send collaboration requests and coordinate event details via in-app messaging.
- Create and manage "stitches" (collaborative events) with partner businesses.
- View and track ongoing collaborations in a centralized community hub.

tools used

We built our high-fi using the following tools:

- React Native (Frontend Framework)
- Supabase (Backend async storage)
- Figma (Design)
- VS Code (IDE)
- Expo (Run & Test)
- AI Tools Used: Figma Make

operating instructions

Download the Expo Go app. Scan the QR code below to launch the app. Click Sign In and use this account for demo purposes: Email: cookie@demo.com, password: test1234



Onboarding

The onboarding process enables small businesses to create a complete profile that powers Stitch's AI-driven partner matching and collaboration discovery. Users begin on the Stitch welcome screen, which displays the app logo and two options: "Log In" and "Sign Up." In this high-fidelity prototype, both options are functional. To sign up, the user completes a three-step flow:

- Step 1: Enter basic business information, including name, business type, business address, email address, and password.
- Step 2: Provide a description of the business, what they are seeking in a collaboration, and their collaboration preferences. This information enables our AI system to recommend the most relevant and compatible businesses nearby.
- Step 3: Select business tags from a predefined list, such as business type or identifiers like *Minority-Owned* or *Family-Owned*.

After completing these steps, the user is successfully registered as a small business on the platform.

Finally, the user is guided through a three-step onboarding tutorial that introduces key terms (e.g., "Stitch Now") and familiarizes them with the app's main tabs, such as:

"Discover Collaboration Opportunities. Browse community posts or let AI suggest perfect matches based on your interests and business goals."

Tasks

There are 3 main tasks a user should accomplish on the Stitch App. They are outlined below, with screenshots of taskflows to complete these tasks.

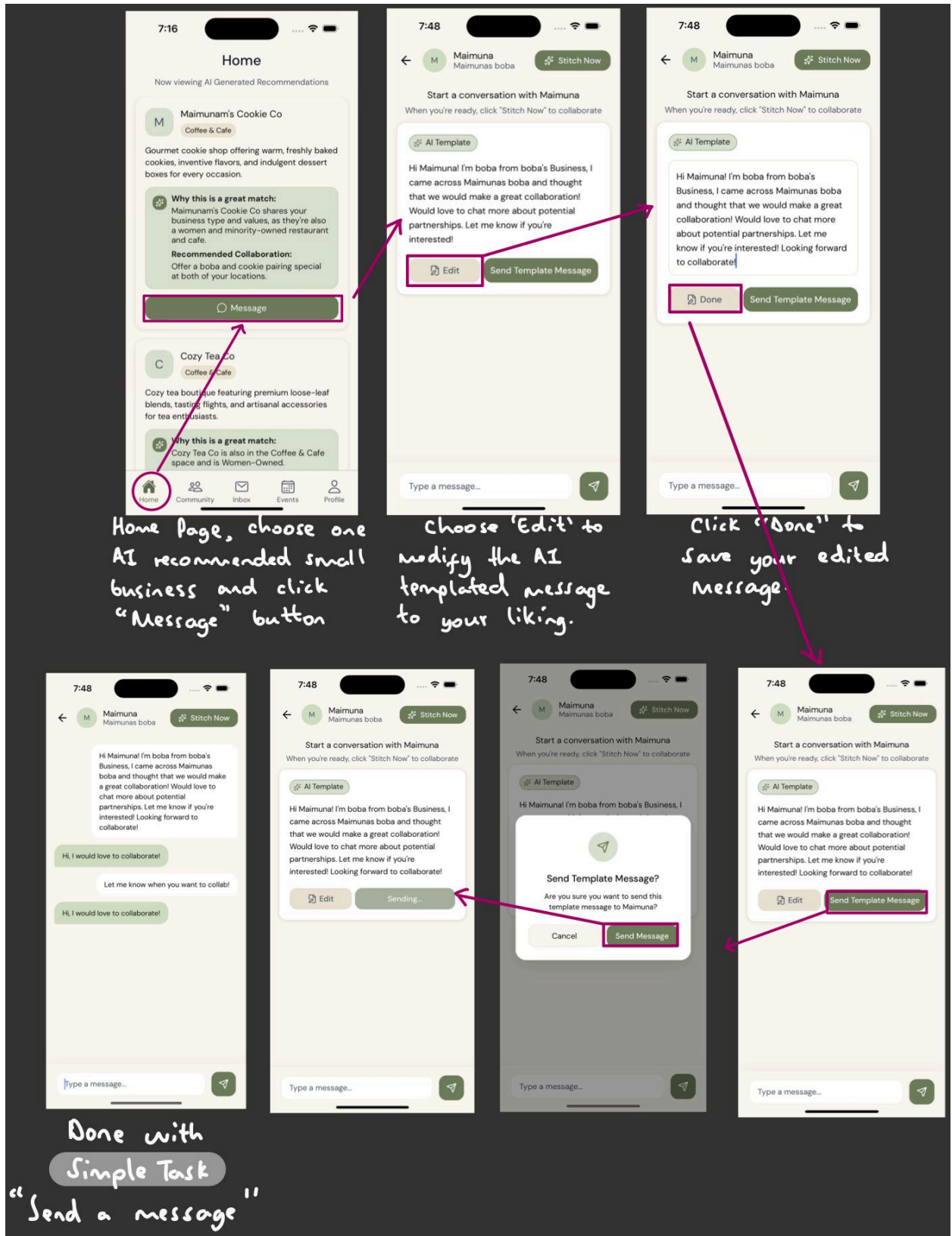
In the **Simple Task**, the user sends a collaboration message by selecting an AI-recommended business from the home feed and tapping “Send Message,” where they can immediately send an AI-templated message to begin a partnership conversation.

In the **Medium Task**, the user formalizes a collaboration by navigating to their inbox, opening an existing conversation, and tapping “Stitch Now” to create an event; they fill out the event form, choose a date, and submit it, after which the event is approved and added to the Communities page.

In the **Complex Task**, Stitch demonstrates how users manage ongoing collaborations: after completing an event, they mark it as finished, provide feedback, and optionally set up a recurring version of the event, allowing them to transform one successful stitch into a sustained partnership.

Together, these tasks show how Stitch supports the full lifecycle of small-business collaborations, from first contact to repeated community events.

- Simple Task: Send a collaboration message.



- Medium Task: Stitch an event.

After sending messages to initiate collab, click 'Stitch Now' to finalize event details

Fill in event details & 'Stitch Now'

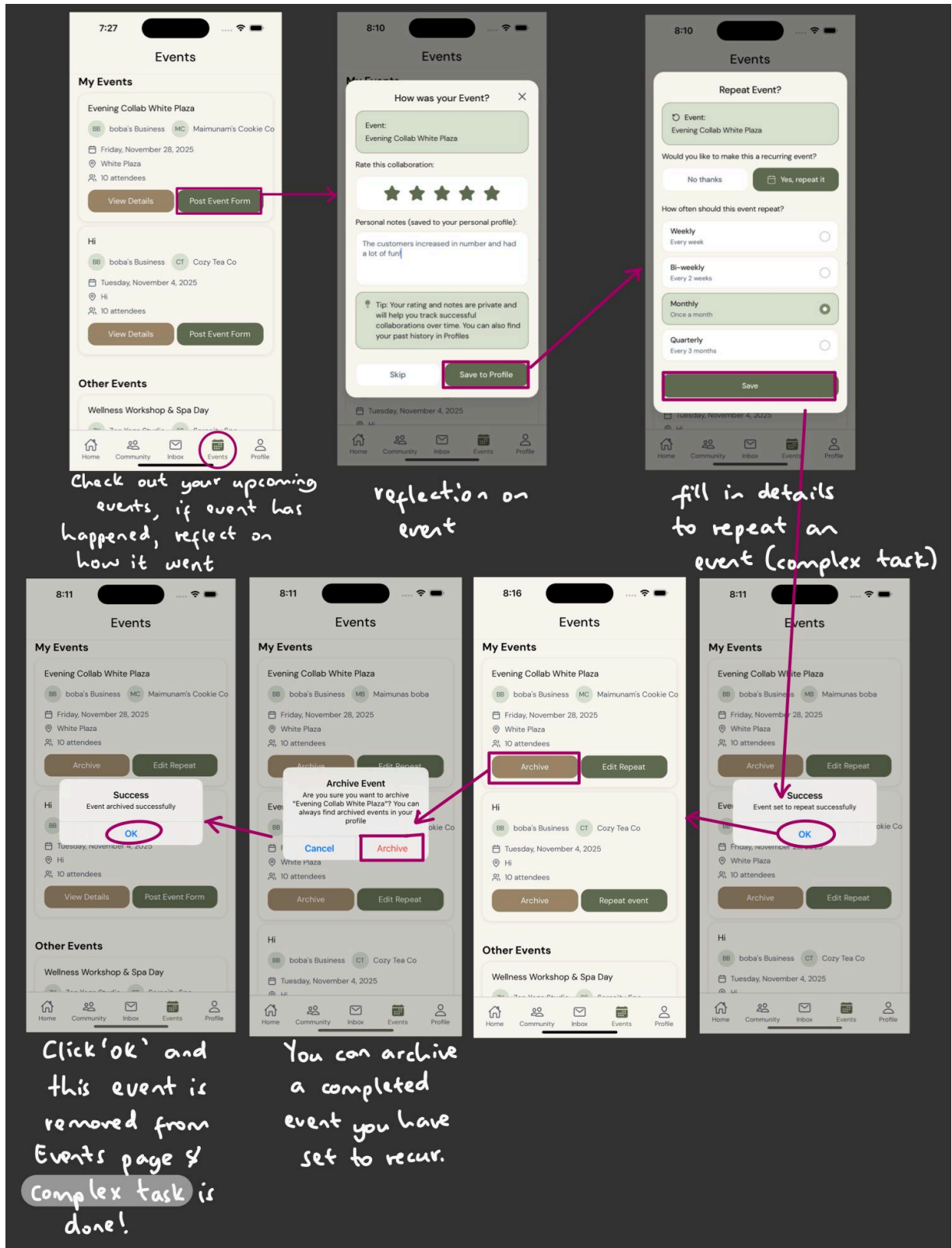
Click 'check it out in events' button to see stitched event details

Click "View Details" button to learn more details about your event

Click 'save' to save any changes then done with medium task

You can click "Edit Details" to edit collab details

- Complex Task: Collaborate on an event multiple times.



limitations

The limitations of the high-fidelity prototype include: not all the business types' tags are included in the list displayed to the user who is creating an account with us. If a business doesn't select any of these tags, when their profile is created, they are assigned coffee&cade, minority-owned, and family-owned business as the default tags. There is no like count or comment count under the posts in the communities tab. Moreover, the button "stitch now" is not functional when there are no messages between the two businesses. This is intentional because we only want to Stitch two businesses after they have agreed to do so, so that we promote meaningful collaboration. Because of a lag from the Supabase database, once a user sends the AI-templated message, they have to refresh the app/inbox by closing and opening the inbox again to get the response. Lastly, the app only offers the option to message another business; there is no option to call or email the other business instead.

wizard of oz techniques

Our app incorporates a couple of Wizard of Oz techniques. When a user creates a stitch, it is automatically approved in 800ms since there is no one else on the other end of our app to approve it. Additionally, if the Gemini API being used to recommend small businesses to the logged-in user does not find the address of this user to match them with businesses nearby, it returns 8 hardcoded recommendations as the fallback, so the user never sees no recommendations.

hard-coded items

The user receives a response when they send a message if their message includes the word “collab” in it. This is so that we can simulate the real-life messaging experience since our app is unidirectional.

accessibility considerations and limitations

Included in the prototype:

- High colour contrast between text and backgrounds
- Large, readable button sizes
- Clear tab structure and navigational hierarchy
- Avoidance of dense text blocks

limitations:

- No screen-reader labels or alt-text
- No haptic feedback or vibration cues